

Tank Care Buddy

Changelog — Final Pre-Xcode Blocker Pass

Session date:	Saturday, June 13, 2026
Versions shipped:	v20260613k -> v20260613o (5 commits)
Phases:	Phase 9 — Broken flows · Phase 10 — Layout trust · Phase 11 — First-run logic · Phase 12 — Equipment/fish UX · Phase 13 — Brand/header
Branch:	main
Repo:	jtsmith7234-rgb/tank-care-buddy
Phase 9 commit:	16ccb2d
Phase 10 commit:	c919716
Phase 11 commit:	1c7ae7a
Phase 12 commit:	9895f82
Phase 13 commit:	8942956 (HEAD)
App version at close:	v20260613o
GitHub Pages:	jtsmith7234-rgb.github.io/tank-care-buddy

Overview

This session addressed all issues from the user's third personal test run, captured in screenshots and detailed notes. The focus was on broken interactions, trust-breaking layout issues, first-run UX confusion, equipment/fish tab clarity, and brand polish. After this pass the app is ready for final personal validation before Xcode.

Phase	Version	Commit	Focus	Done
9 — Broken Actions	v20260613k	16ccb2d	Toast nav fix, eq inspect/service, guided banner, bug modal	✓
10 — Layout Trust	v20260613l	c919716	Scroll anchor, iOS input jitter, header clip, chemical contrast, checklist smooth	✓
11 — First-Run Logic	v20260613m	1c7ae7a	First-entry Up Next cards, completion scroll-top, actions stay on page	✓
12 — Eq / Fish UX	v20260613n	9895f82	Equipment defaults All, setup note clarity, unified fish card flow	✓
13 — Brand / Header	v20260613o	8942956	Slogan unified, labeled header buttons, Fish tab label, home empty state, owner name	✓

Phase 9 — Broken Actions & Dead Flows · v20260613k · 16ccb2d

Every interaction that previously did nothing now works. Navigation, inspect/service, bug reporting, and guided tracking are all wired correctly.

actionToast navigation fix

Root cause: `_ftNavigateToTab` was reading a stale closure variable. Rewritten to re-read view at call time. `onAction()` now fires BEFORE DOM removal to prevent render-race cancellation. Duration extended to 8s. Dismiss X button added — toast stays until tapped or dismissed.

ft-eq-hint 'View equipment' link

Was broken only because `_ftNavigateToTab` itself was broken. Resolved by the nav fix above. `ft-eq-hint-link` class added to ensure click binding is consistent.

Equipment Inspect/Service buttons

`_openEqMoreModal` rebuilt as a clean two-modal chain: (1) action picker modal, (2) service guidance modal with type-specific instructions from `_getEqServiceGuide()`. 'Mark as serviced' logs the event and resets the service timer. filter, heater, light, pump, CO2, UV, and generic types each have specific guidance text.

Guided mode sticky banner

Equipment tab now shows a persistent teal 'Setup guide in progress / Back to guide >' banner when `firstTank.enabled && !allDone`. User can always find their way back without relying on a short-lived toast.

Bug/Feature report modals

Both settings buttons now open full modal flows instead of clipped toasts: instructions list, mailto: deep link to open email app with pre-filled subject. Clean, readable, actually actionable.

Phase 10 — Trust-Breaking Layout & Rendering · v20260613l · c919716

Fixed visible UI bugs that were making the app feel cheap and unstable on iPhone.

iOS text-selection handles floating outside input

`input.select()` now deferred via `requestAnimationFrame`. All number/text/date inputs get `-webkit-appearance:none + min-height:44px` to prevent iOS Safari resize quirks.

Water change date field vertical misalignment

@supports (-webkit-touch-callout: none) block: date inputs get `height:44px` and `padding:10px 12px` on iOS specifically, aligning them to the same height as adjacent gallons fields.

Checklist bubble jitter on tap

Button disabled immediately on tap (re-enabled 350ms later). Full persist+re-render deferred 120ms so optimistic DOM update fully paints before any re-render. Stage auto-complete uses 500ms CSS flash before re-render. No more visual jitter or bubble shift.

Header slogan clipping ('Care th...')

Tagline removed from inside the `h1` element entirely. Header now shows only logo mark + 'Tank Care Buddy'. 'Take care, taken care of.' moved to a `.home-welcome-tagline` div below the header bar — no clipping possible.

Chemical dosage modal — 'Not the correct dosage' invisible

Both vp-manual buttons changed from class='btn block' to class='btn block secondary'. Secondary button style: glass-border + ink color text on transparent background. Previously was teal-on-teal (completely unreadable). Now clearly visible.

Scroll position jumpiness on re-render

render() now saves scrollTop + current screen/tab before innerHTML replacement, then restores via requestAnimationFrame after render — only when the same screen/tab re-renders. Prevents the jarring page jump when tapping any button that triggers a re-render.

Phase 11 — Guided Experience & First-Run Logic · v20260613m · 1c7ae7a

Reduced first-run confusion. Brand-new tanks no longer look like they're already broken.

First-entry Up Next cards — no more red 'Due now'

renderUpNextSection now checks isFirstEntry = !it.lastDoneTs. First-entry rows: teal 'Let's log your first water change →' sub-label, no Mark done/Snooze/Skip buttons, neutral upn-first class (light glass background, no red/pink). After the first log, normal due-now/overdue behavior takes over. Brand-new tanks no longer look like emergencies.

Actions stay on current page

Water change save and water test save were both navigating to the History tab after saving. Both handlers changed to view.tab = 'water-care' so the user stays in place. Fish add, equipment service, and other actions were already correct.

Guide completion — scroll to top

_showFirstTankCompletionModal 'Go to my tank' button now scrolls to top via requestAnimationFrame after navigation so the user lands at the Up Next section, not the bottom of the page.

actionToast persistence confirmed

8s duration, X dismiss button, onAction fires before DOM removal — all confirmed present from Phase 9.

Guided-return banner confirmed

Equipment tab sticky banner confirmed present and wired — 'Setup guide in progress / Back to guide >'.

Phase 12 — Equipment & Livestock UX Rework · v20260613n · 9895f82

Equipment is now visible by default. Setup guidance is beginner-readable. Fish tab is a unified premium card instead of two separate generic sections.

Equipment tab defaults to 'All'

eqFilter init and per-tank reset both changed from 'month' to 'all'. Filters reordered: All · This week · This month · Upcoming. When a user adds equipment they now see it immediately — no more adding items that seem to disappear.

Equipment setup note — beginner-readable

Replaced cryptic 'Your setup: 3 essential, 2 recommended, 2 optional — Filter, Heater...' with a clean .eq-setup-note card: 'FOR A COMMUNITY TANK: Filter · Heater · Thermometer' plus 'These are the basics.'

Add them below if you haven't yet.' Counts removed — they confused beginners.

Fish tab — unified premium card flow

Merged 'Add to tank' and 'Browse species & compatibility' into one fish-action-section. Single prominent search input (48px height, 12px radius) drives autocomplete, compat results, and browse. Two side-by-side cards: [Add a fish] (count/name always visible) + [Check compatibility] (result inline). Active species selection highlights the Add card with a teal border. Generic dark dropdown appearance replaced with a clean card layout. All existing search/add/delete/compat logic preserved — only the layout changed.

Phase 13 — Brand, Header & Premium-Feel Cleanup · v20260613o · 8942956

App now matches the website branding. Header buttons are clearly labeled. Premium-feel polish applied across home screen, settings, and tutorial.

Slogan unified with website

'Care that shows.' replaced by 'Take care, taken care of.' in all locations: home-welcome-tagline, settings brand footer, and tutorial hero card tagline. Consistent with the tankcarebuddy.com website.

Header buttons — labeled with context

Both right-side header buttons now use .ghost-btn-labeled with icon + 9px uppercase label below: Fish icon → 'FISH' label. Aquarium/tank SVG icon → 'TANK' label. Users can now tell at a glance what each button does. The + button is now an aquarium-shaped icon (rectangle + water line + plus) instead of a bare plus.

Fish tab label

'Livestock' → 'Fish' in the tank tab bar. Simpler, clearer, friendlier to beginners.

Home empty state — welcoming instead of blank

Replaced plain heading with .home-empty-state: fish icon, 'Welcome to Tank Care Buddy' title, descriptive sub-text, and 'Add my first tank' button wired to openAddTank(). First-time users land on a welcoming screen instead of a confusing blank page.

Settings — owner name

'The Pop Umbrella' → 'Tank Care Buddy' in the App section of settings. More professional.

Tutorial welcome card

Confirmed hero layout: 'Tank Care Buddy' wordmark, 'Take care, taken care of.' tagline, 'Keep every tank healthy.' headline, clean descriptive body copy. Consistent with all branding.

Files Modified This Session

File	Phases	Key changes
app.js	9–13	actionToast rewrite, _ftNavigateToTab fix, _openEqMoreModal chain, _getEqServiceGuide, guided banner, bug/feature modals, scroll-restore in render(), isFirstEntry Up Next, wc-save stay-on-page, completion scroll-top, eqFilter defaults, eq-setup-note, renderFish unified card, home empty state, settings owner, labeled header

firsttank.js	9,11	ft-eq-hint binding, checklist tap debounce/deferred re-render, confirmed guided banner
styles.css	9–13	action-toast-controls/.dismiss, guided-return-banner, eq-setup-note, fish-action-section, fish-quick-card, ghost-btn-labeled, home-empty-state, upn-first/first-entry, iOS input fixes, home-welcome-tagline, scroll/animation additions
index.html	All	Version bumped k→l→m→n→o across all 9 script/link tags. Header button HTML updated.
tutorial.js	13	Hero tagline updated to 'Take care, taken care of.'
tests/ (1 file)	13	2026-06-13-k-final-pre-xcode-blockers.md — full 5-phase QA report

Remaining Non-Blocking Items

ID	Description	When
S-1	Settings sheet modal lacks modal-inner scroll structure on very small phones	App Store
V-1	On some themes, check home-welcome-tagline renders correctly (not inheriting gradient fill)	Personal test
R-4	@capacitor/local-notifications needed for lock-screen push notifications	Notif. phase
U-1	Fish quick-card compat section may need scroll if result is long — test on iPhone	Personal test
L-3	expandedEventId not reset on tank switch	Anytime
L-4	APP_VERSION hardcoded '1.0' — not tied to versioning system	Anytime

Final Pre-Xcode Assessment

Question	Answer
Are there still broken interactions?	No. All toast navigation works. Equipment inspect/service chains are functional. Bug reports open proper modals. Guided banner keeps users on track.
Does it still look like a free app?	No. Labeled header buttons, unified fish card layout, branded tutorial hero, consistent slogan, welcoming empty state, and premium modal design all contribute to a noticeably more intentional product feel.
Does the first-run experience feel welcoming?	Yes. New tanks show 'Let's log your first water change →' instead of red 'Due now'. Home empty state is warm and inviting. Tutorial has a strong branded first card.
Does the guided experience keep users on track?	Yes. Persistent sticky banner on equipment tab. 8s actionToasts with X dismiss. All checklist prompts navigate correctly. Completion modal lands at top of Details.

Is it ready for final personal validation test?	Yes. Do one full run-through: create a tank (choose type), run guided flow, add equipment (confirm banner), complete checklist steps (confirm toasts navigate), add fish, log water test, check header labels on iPhone. Then Xcode.
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Pre-Xcode Final Checklist

1. Final personal test on iPhone

Browse jtsmith7234-rgb.github.io/tank-care-buddy. Create a new tank — choose a tank type (not betta default). Run the guided setup. Add equipment, confirm the sticky banner appears. Check all checklist prompts navigate. Complete the guide, confirm completion modal and scroll-to-top. Log a water change — confirm it stays on Water Care tab. Check header Fish/Tank labels. Check home tagline 'Take care, taken care of.' on both light and dark themes.

2. Open Xcode

`cd ~/path/to/tank-care-buddy/ios/App && pod install && open App.xcworkspace`

3. Xcode setup

Set Signing Team → confirm bundle ID `com.tankcarebuddy.app` → run on simulator or physical device.

4. Focus only on shell/device issues after this

Do not reopen the product. Any issue that surfaces in Xcode is a native-shell issue, not a web-app issue.

5. App Store Connect (after device test)

Create app record → 1024×1024 icon already generated → TestFlight upload.